

DOMINO'S

PIZZA

Franchise Business Analysis Report

An In-Depth Study of Company Profile · Franchise Relationships · Statistical Insights · Trend Analysis · Challenges & Key Takeaways

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

01	Introduction & Company Profile	Pg 3
02	Franchisor–Franchisee Relationship	Pg 6
03	Statistical Information	Pg 9
04	Pros and Cons Faced	Pg 13
05	Trend Analysis: From Inception to Present	Pg 17
06	Understanding & Key Takeaways from Challenges	Pg 21
07	Conclusion	Pg 24

CHAPTER 01

Introduction & Company Profile

About Domino's Pizza

Domino's Pizza, officially known as Domino's Inc., is one of the world's largest and most recognized pizza restaurant chains. Founded in 1960 in Ypsilanti, Michigan, USA, by brothers Tom and James Monaghan, the brand has grown from a single pizza store into a global franchise empire spanning more than 90 countries with over 20,000 locations worldwide. The company's headquarter is located in Ann Arbor, Michigan, and it is publicly traded on the New York Stock Exchange (NYSE: DPZ).

Domino's built its reputation on a deceptively simple value proposition: delivering hot, fresh pizza quickly and reliably. This focus on delivery efficiency — rather than dine-in experience — was revolutionary for its time and became the cornerstone of its global brand identity. Today, Domino's is not merely a pizza chain; it is a technology-driven, logistics-focused franchise powerhouse.

Founding Story

In 1960, Tom Monaghan and his brother James purchased a small pizza restaurant called 'DomiNick's' in Ypsilanti, Michigan for \$500. James later traded his share of the business for a used Volkswagen Beetle, leaving Tom as the sole owner. After expanding to a second location, the original owner of the DomiNick's name refused to allow it to be used for additional stores. A delivery driver suggested 'Domino's,' and the name has endured ever since.

The company's iconic logo — a domino tile with three dots — originally represented the three stores the company operated at that time, with the intention of adding a dot for every new store opened. As the company grew exponentially, this plan became impractical, but the logo remained, symbolizing the brand's foundational heritage.

Corporate Snapshot

Founded	December 9, 1960
Founders	Tom Monaghan & James Monaghan
Headquarters	Ann Arbor, Michigan, USA
CEO (Current)	Russell Weiner
Ticker Symbol	NYSE: DPZ
Global Locations	20,000+ in 90+ countries
Annual Revenue	~\$4.53 Billion (2023)
Employees	~10,000 corporate + 200,000+ franchise
Business Model	Primarily Franchise-Based (~98%)

Core Products	Pizza, Pasta, Sandwiches, Desserts, Beverages
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Mission, Vision & Core Values

Mission Statement:

"Exceptional franchisees and team members on a mission to be the best pizza delivery company " in the world, in every neighborhood."

Core Values:

- **Putting People First:** Prioritizing team members, franchisees, and customers in every decision.
- **Delivering with Integrity:** Doing the right thing even when no one is watching.
- **Winning Together:** Collaborative success built on mutual trust and shared goals.
- **Hungry to Innovate:** Continuously seeking better technology, products, and processes.
- **Celebrating Excellence:** Recognizing and rewarding outstanding performance.

Global Footprint

Domino's global reach is vast and continues to expand. The brand operates across six continents, with particularly strong presences in North America, South Asia (especially India, where Jubilant FoodWorks Limited is the master franchisee), the United Kingdom, Australia, and Latin America. Domino's India alone operates over 1,900 stores, making it one of the largest pizza chains in the Asian subcontinent.

Region	Store Count (Approx.)	Key Markets
North America	6,700+	USA, Canada
Asia Pacific	5,800+	India, Japan, Australia, China
Europe	3,900+	UK, Germany, France
Latin America	1,800+	Mexico, Brazil
Middle East & Africa	1,200+	Saudi Arabia, South Africa
Other Markets	800+	Various

CHAPTER 02

Franchisor–Franchisee Relationship

Overview of the Franchise Model

Domino's Pizza operates predominantly through a franchise model, with approximately 98% of its global stores being franchisee-owned. This makes Domino's one of the most franchise-dependent major food chains in the world. Under this model, Domino's (the franchisor) grants independent business owners (franchisees) the right to operate a Domino's store using its brand, systems, recipes, and operational frameworks in exchange for fees and royalties.

Franchise Structure: Types of Ownership

Single-Unit Franchise

Franchisee owns and operates one store. Ideal for first-time entrepreneurs. This is the most common starting point for new Domino's franchisees.

Multi-Unit Franchise

A proven operator who owns multiple Domino's stores under one agreement. Domino's actively encourages multi-unit ownership for scaling.

Master Franchise Agreement

Large companies or individuals who acquire the right to develop and sub-franchise an entire country or territory. Example: Jubilant FoodWorks in India, DP Eurasia in Turkey and Russia.

Financial Obligations of a Franchisee

Fee Type	Amount / Rate	Frequency
Initial Franchise Fee	\$10,000 (USA)	One-Time
Royalty Fee	5.5% of gross sales	Weekly
Advertising Fund Contribution	6% of gross sales	Weekly
Estimated Total Investment	\$150,000 – \$500,000+	Initial Setup
Renewal Fee	\$1,500 per unit	Every 10 Years
Technology Fee	~\$200/month	Monthly

Note: Investment amounts vary significantly by country, location (urban vs rural), store format (delivery-only vs dine-in), and local construction/labor costs. Indian franchisee investment typically ranges between ■30 lakh to ■1.5 crore.

Rights & Responsibilities

What the Franchisor (Domino's) Provides:

- Brand licensing and use of the Domino's trademark and trade dress
- Standardized recipes, ingredients, and proprietary food systems
- Comprehensive initial training program (minimum 3-4 weeks at a certified training store)
- Access to the Domino's PULSE point-of-sale and management system
- Ongoing operational support, field consulting, and quality audits
- National and regional advertising campaigns funded by the Ad Fund
- New product development and menu innovation
- Technology infrastructure including ordering apps and delivery tracking

Franchisee Obligations:

- Maintain strict brand standards, store cleanliness, and product quality
- Use only approved suppliers for ingredients, packaging, and equipment
- Hire, train, and manage all store-level employees
- Pay all fees on time: royalties, advertising, and technology fees
- Participate in local store marketing (LSM) activities
- Adhere to Domino's operational standards and franchise agreement terms
- Reinvest in store improvements and technology upgrades as required

Conflict Resolution & Support Mechanisms

Domino's maintains a Franchise Advisory Council (FAC) in the United States and similar bodies in other markets. This council gives franchisees a formal voice in matters of policy, marketing spending, and product development. Disputes between the franchisor and franchisees are typically handled through structured mediation processes outlined in the Franchise Disclosure Document (FDD). Domino's has, on multiple occasions, faced legal disputes from franchisees over issues such as territory encroachment, mandatory technology upgrades, and advertising fund allocation.

Franchisee Success: Training & Development

Domino's invests heavily in franchisee education. The Domino's College of Pizzerology is a flagship training concept where new and existing franchisees undergo intensive learning in operations, customer service, and business management. On-the-job training at approved training stores is mandatory, and ongoing e-learning modules keep franchisees up to date with new systems and procedures. This structured approach has resulted in a relatively low franchisee failure rate compared to the broader restaurant industry.

CHAPTER 03

Statistical Information

This chapter presents a data-driven overview of Domino's Pizza's financial performance, store growth, operational metrics, and market position, offering quantitative context for understanding the company's scale and trajectory.

Key Performance Indicators at a Glance



Revenue & Financial Performance (2018–2023)

Year	Revenue (USD Billion)	Net Income (USD Million)	Stores Worldwide
2018	\$3.43B	\$361M	15,914
2019	\$3.62B	\$415M	17,020
2020	\$4.12B	\$491M	17,644
2021	\$4.36B	\$530M	18,848
2022	\$4.49B	\$447M	19,519
2023	\$4.53B	\$461M	20,031

Source: Domino's Pizza Annual Reports 2018–2023

Same-Store Sales Growth (SSSG)

Same-store sales growth is a critical retail and restaurant metric, measuring revenue change at established stores (open at least 12 months). Domino's has maintained consistently positive SSSG for over a decade, demonstrating the strength of its operational model and customer loyalty.

Year	US SSSG	International SSSG	Global SSSG
2018	+6.6%	+3.6%	+5.1%
2019	+3.9%	+1.6%	+2.8%
2020	+11.5%	+5.4%	+8.5%
2021	+3.5%	+8.9%	+6.2%

2022	+2.9%	+0.2%	+1.6%
2023	+2.7%	+2.5%	+2.6%

Digital & Delivery Statistics

Domino's transformation into a technology-first company is reflected in its digital order metrics. By 2023, digital channels accounted for over 80% of all orders globally, demonstrating a fundamental shift in consumer behavior that Domino's has proactively embraced and amplified.

Metric	Value	Year
Digital Order Share (US)	>80%	2023
Active Loyalty Members	30+ Million	2023
Domino's App Downloads (Cumulative)	100M+	2023
Average Delivery Time (US)	~23 Minutes	2023
Countries with Online Ordering	85+	2023
Weekly Online Transactions	~7 Million	2023

Store Network Growth

Domino's store count has grown nearly fourfold since 2000, reflecting sustained franchise demand. The company's net unit growth strategy targets approximately 800–1,000 new stores annually, with developing markets like India, China, and Southeast Asia offering the greatest near-term expansion opportunities.

Year	Total Stores	Net New Stores	% International
2000	5,239	—	38%
2005	8,029	+556/yr avg	47%
2010	9,351	+264/yr avg	52%
2015	12,261	+582/yr avg	57%
2020	17,644	+1,077/yr avg	64%
2023	20,031	+796/yr avg	67%

CHAPTER 04

Pros and Cons Faced

Like any major global business, Domino's Pizza faces a complex landscape of advantages and disadvantages — from the perspective of the corporate entity, its franchisees, customers, and society at large. This chapter provides a balanced, comprehensive analysis.

ADVANTAGES — What Makes Domino's Succeed

1. Iconic Global Brand Recognition

The Domino's brand is instantly recognizable in over 90 countries. Decades of consistent branding, memorable slogans ('30 minutes or it's free'), and aggressive marketing have created a brand with extraordinary recall value. New franchisees benefit from this pre-built customer trust from day one.

2. Franchise-First Business Model

With ~98% franchise ownership, Domino's has a capital-light business model. The franchisor receives royalties and fees without bearing most of the operational risk. This enables rapid global expansion with lower corporate capital expenditure, benefiting shareholders.

3. Technology Leadership

Domino's has consistently been a first mover in digital ordering innovation. It launched ordering via text message, smart TVs, voice assistants, and social media. The proprietary PULSE POS system and real-time GPS delivery tracking set industry standards. By 2023, 80%+ of US orders were placed digitally.

4. Delivery-Focused Infrastructure

Unlike competitors who retrofitted delivery onto dine-in models, Domino's was built for delivery from inception. This gives it inherent operational advantages — store layouts, supply chains, and workforce training are all optimized for fast, accurate delivery.

5. Domino's Rewards Loyalty Program

With 30+ million active members in the US alone, the Domino's Rewards program drives repeat purchases, data collection, and personalization. Loyalty members order more frequently and spend more per visit than non-members.

6. Supply Chain Strength

Domino's operates its own supply chain network — Domino's Pizza LLC's vertically integrated commissary system — supplying dough, sauces, and cheese directly to stores. This ensures quality consistency and reduces franchisee procurement complexity.

7. Affordable Price Point

Domino's positions itself as a value brand, making it accessible during economic downturns. During recessions and inflation cycles, consumers often trade down from full-service restaurants to value-oriented QSR brands like

Domino's.

DISADVANTAGES — Key Challenges & Weaknesses

1. Intense Competition

The QSR and pizza market is fiercely competitive. Domino's faces pressure from global brands (Pizza Hut, Papa John's, Little Caesars), local/regional chains, third-party delivery aggregators (DoorDash, Uber Eats, Swiggy, Zomato), and increasingly, ghost kitchens and cloud restaurants that can undercut on price.

2. Franchisee Quality Control Challenges

With 20,000+ independently owned locations, enforcing uniform quality standards is an enormous operational challenge. Inconsistent product quality, hygiene issues, and service failures at individual franchise locations can damage the global brand. Franchisee turnover and financial distress also create service gaps.

3. High-Calorie Product Portfolio

Growing global health consciousness has put fast food brands under scrutiny. Domino's core menu of pizzas, pasta, and desserts is calorie-dense and processed. Despite some healthier options, the brand struggles to attract health-focused consumers, and may face future regulatory pressure on nutritional labeling.

4. Dependence on Delivery Workforce

Domino's relies heavily on delivery drivers, making it vulnerable to labor shortages, wage increases, and driver retention challenges. In markets with high minimum wage legislation, labor costs significantly compress franchisee margins.

5. Currency & Geopolitical Risk

As a company earning significant revenues internationally, Domino's is exposed to currency exchange fluctuations. Political instability, trade restrictions, or regulatory changes in key markets can adversely impact earnings. The Russia-Ukraine conflict directly impacted operations in Eastern Europe.

6. Supply Chain Inflation Sensitivity

Cheese, wheat (for dough), and cooking oils — Domino's primary ingredients — are globally traded commodities subject to volatile price swings. Ingredient cost spikes directly impact margins, particularly for smaller franchisees.

7. Third-Party Delivery Platform Pressure

The rise of DoorDash, Uber Eats, and Grubhub created a dilemma for Domino's. Initially resistant (preferring its own delivery), Domino's eventually partnered with Uber Eats in 2023, accepting that consumer preference for aggregator platforms required adapting its historically closed delivery model.

CHAPTER 05

Trend Analysis: From Inception to Present

This chapter traces Domino's evolution through distinct strategic phases — from its origins as a single-store pizza delivery operation to its current status as a technology-enabled global franchise leader.

Era 1: 1960–1978 | The Foundation Years

- 1960: Tom Monaghan purchases DomiNick's pizza for \$500.
- 1965: First franchise store opened in Ypsilanti, Michigan.
- 1967: The name 'Domino's Pizza' is officially adopted.
- 1975: Amstar Corp. sues over use of 'Domino' name; Domino's wins the case.
- 1978: The 200th Domino's store opens; rapid franchise growth begins.
- Focus was on speed, simplicity, and delivery-only operations.

Era 2: 1979–1997 | Rapid Domestic Expansion

- 1983: First international store opens in Winnipeg, Canada.
- 1985: Japanese market entry — among first US pizza chains in Asia.
- 1985: The famous '30 minutes or it's free' guarantee launches.
- 1989: 5,000th store opens globally.
- 1993: 30-minute guarantee is retired over road safety liability concerns.
- 1997: 1,500 international locations across 55 countries.

Era 3: 1998–2009 | Private Equity, IPO & Digital Awakening

- 1998: Tom Monaghan sells 93% of Domino's to Bain Capital for \$1 billion.
- 2003: Dave Brandon becomes CEO, drives operational and brand reforms.
- 2004: Domino's goes public on NYSE under ticker DPZ.
- 2007: Online ordering launches — a pivotal digital milestone.
- 2008: Domino's launches iPhone app, pioneering mobile ordering.
- 2009: J. Patrick Doyle becomes CEO; initiates bold reinvention strategy.

Era 4: 2010–2018 | The Pizza Turnaround & Tech Revolution

- 2010: Public recipe reformulation — Domino's admits to old pizza failures on TV.
- 2011: 'Domino's Tracker' real-time delivery tracking launches.
- 2012: 5,000+ digital ordering platforms including voice, smart TV.
- 2014: 'Zero-Click' ordering app introduced.
- 2015: AnyWare ordering — Twitter, Google Home, Amazon Echo integration.
- 2018: Stock price grows 2,000%+ over the decade — one of NYSE's top performers.

Era 5: 2019–2024 | Pandemic Surge, Staffing & Aggregator Adaptation

- 2020: COVID-19 pandemic drives unprecedented delivery demand — SSSG +11.5%.
- 2021: 'Fortressing' strategy: denser store network for faster delivery.
- 2021: Russell Weiner becomes President; CEO transition initiated.
- 2022: Domino's exits Russia following Ukraine invasion.
- 2022: Labor shortages challenge delivery operations; carryout promotions expanded.
- 2023: Domino's partners with Uber Eats — historic shift from owned-delivery exclusivity.
- 2024: Continued expansion in India, Southeast Asia, and Middle East.

Stock Price Performance: A Decade of Dominance

Domino's is frequently cited as one of the best-performing stocks of the 2010s on the NYSE. From its IPO price of \$14.00 per share in 2004, DPZ climbed to a peak of approximately \$567 in 2021 — representing a 40x return for early investors. This extraordinary performance was driven by consistent earnings growth, a shareholder-friendly buyback program, rising digital revenues, and the effective franchise model that generates high-margin royalty income at scale.

Year	Approx. Stock Price	Key Driver
2004 (IPO)	\$14	NYSE Listing
2010	\$18	Recipe reformulation buzz
2013	\$55	Digital ordering growth
2016	\$150	Tech-first strategy validated
2018	\$300	Consistent SSSG, global expansion
2021 (Peak)	\$567	Pandemic delivery boom
2023	\$~380	Post-peak normalization

CHAPTER 06

Understanding & Key Takeaways from Challenges Faced

Every great business is shaped as much by its failures and challenges as by its successes. Domino's history offers exceptional case studies in strategic resilience, consumer-centric reinvention, and adaptive management. This chapter extracts the most important learnings.

Challenge 1: The Pizza Quality Crisis (2008–2010)

By 2008, Domino's pizza had become the butt of jokes. Consumer surveys ranked Domino's last among major pizza chains in taste. A viral social media video by rogue employees showing unsanitary kitchen practices went viral on YouTube, causing significant brand damage.

Domino's Response:

New CEO Patrick Doyle made an unprecedented decision: Domino's publicly acknowledged that its pizza was bad and announced a complete recipe overhaul. A national ad campaign called 'Pizza Turnaround' aired real customers criticizing the old pizza, followed by the reveal of the new recipe. This radical transparency was a masterclass in brand crisis management.

■ Key Takeaway:

Transparency and radical honesty can transform a weakness into a marketing advantage. Consumers reward brands that acknowledge mistakes and show genuine improvement.

Challenge 2: The '30 Minutes or Free' Liability Crisis (1993)

Domino's iconic guarantee created a culture where delivery drivers felt pressure to speed. By the early 1990s, a series of accidents involving Domino's delivery drivers — some fatal — resulted in massive legal liabilities. A 1993 lawsuit resulted in an \$78 million judgment against the company.

Domino's Response:

Domino's permanently retired the 30-minute guarantee, replacing it with a focus on 'hot, fresh pizza delivered at a time you specify.' This shifted brand positioning from speed-above-all to quality and reliability.

■ Key Takeaway:

Promotional strategies must account for real-world second-order consequences. A powerful marketing tool can create dangerous incentive structures if not carefully managed. Brands must prioritize safety over brand promises.

Challenge 3: Digital Disruption & The Third-Party Aggregator Dilemma

As DoorDash, Uber Eats, and Grubhub gained mass-market adoption, Domino's faced a strategic dilemma. Its own delivery infrastructure was a competitive strength, but a growing segment of customers preferred to discover and order from aggregator platforms. Resistance to listing on these platforms risked losing market share to competitors who embraced them.

Domino's Response:

After years of resistance, Domino's announced a landmark partnership with Uber Eats in 2023, recognizing that consumer convenience preferences must ultimately guide strategy. The company negotiated terms to protect its data and economics while accessing new customer acquisition channels.

■ Key Takeaway:

Even companies with best-in-class proprietary systems must remain open to evolving their ecosystem strategy when market forces demand it. Inflexibility in the face of consumer preference shifts can cost market share.

Challenge 4: Labor Shortages & Delivery Staffing (2021–2023)

The post-pandemic labor market saw unprecedented shortages, particularly in the restaurant and delivery sector. Domino's closed approximately 107 US stores in 2021 due to inability to staff delivery operations. Wage pressures further squeezed franchisee margins.

Domino's Response:

Domino's responded with a 'Carryout Only' promotion strategy, offering significant discounts to customers who picked up their orders. This reduced dependency on delivery drivers while maintaining order volumes. The company also accelerated its investment in automation and electric delivery vehicle trials.

■ Key Takeaway:

Business model flexibility — being able to shift between delivery and carryout as operational conditions change — provides vital resilience against labor market volatility.

Challenge 5: Geopolitical Risk — Russia Exit (2022)

Russia represented a significant Domino's market with hundreds of locations operated by a master franchisee. The Russian invasion of Ukraine in February 2022 created ethical, reputational, and operational pressures on all Western consumer brands operating in Russia.

Domino's Response:

The Russian master franchisee chose to re-brand all stores under a new name rather than comply with Domino's requirement to exit the Russian market. Domino's terminated its Russia franchise agreement, effectively losing a substantial number of stores virtually overnight.

■ Key Takeaway:

Global expansion through master franchise agreements requires careful geopolitical risk assessment and robust contractual mechanisms to manage exit scenarios when political circumstances demand it.

Challenge 6: Nutrition & Health Perception

As consumer health consciousness has grown globally, fast food brands face increasing pressure from regulators (calorie labeling laws), health advocates, and changing consumer preferences. Domino's core menu is seen as indulgent and calorie-dense.

Domino's Response:

Domino's has gradually introduced lighter options, salads, and lower-calorie pizzas in select markets. The company has also committed to improving nutritional transparency, providing detailed calorie and allergen information on its ordering platforms.

■ Key Takeaway:

Long-term brand sustainability requires proactively adapting product portfolios to evolving consumer values. Waiting for regulatory mandates creates reactive brand perception rather than progressive leadership.

CHAPTER 07

Conclusion

Synthesis & Strategic Assessment

Domino's Pizza stands as one of the most compelling case studies in modern business history. From a single borrowed pizza store in 1960, it has grown into a \$20+ billion enterprise operating across more than 90 countries — powered almost entirely by a franchise model that aligns the incentives of independent entrepreneurs with the strategic goals of a global brand.

What distinguishes Domino's from its competitors is not merely scale, but a series of deliberate, often courageous strategic decisions. Few brands in history have publicly acknowledged their product failures and rebuilt from the ground up. Fewer still have invested so heavily in becoming a technology company operating in the food business, rather than a food company dabbling in technology.

Five Pillars of Domino's Enduring Success

- 1. The Franchise Engine:** An exceptionally well-structured franchise system that gives entrepreneurs a proven path to success while providing the corporate entity with capital-light, royalty-rich revenue at scale.
- 2. Technology as Competitive Moat:** Years of investment in ordering platforms, supply chain technology, and data analytics have created barriers to imitation that pure food companies cannot easily replicate.
- 3. Delivery DNA:** Built from inception for delivery — not adapted to it — gives Domino's inherent speed and efficiency advantages that dine-in competitors cannot easily match.
- 4. Radical Accountability:** The willingness to publicly acknowledge failure (the 2010 pizza reinvention) and adapt strategy to market realities (Uber Eats partnership) reflects a management culture that prioritizes long-term brand health over short-term pride.
- 5. Value & Accessibility:** A price-competitive product portfolio ensures Domino's remains relevant across economic cycles, providing defensive characteristics that premium food brands cannot offer.

Challenges on the Horizon

- Sustained labor market pressures and rising minimum wages in key markets
- Intensifying competition from ghost kitchens and cloud restaurant platforms
- Growing consumer health consciousness requiring menu evolution
- Managing quality consistency across 20,000+ franchise locations globally
- Navigating geopolitical volatility in emerging market expansions
- Technology maintenance and cybersecurity at global operating scale
- Environmental and sustainability expectations (packaging, carbon footprint)

Final Observations

The Domino's story demonstrates that sustainable business growth requires more than a good product — it requires adaptability, a clear value proposition, scalable systems, and the courage to make transformational decisions even when it means acknowledging past failures. For aspiring franchisees, business students, and strategic thinkers, Domino's provides a masterclass in brand resilience, franchise management, and technology-driven competitive differentiation.

As the food delivery landscape continues to evolve — with AI-driven personalization, autonomous delivery vehicles, and virtual brand proliferation reshaping the industry — Domino's appears well-positioned to leverage its foundational strengths. The company that once nearly collapsed under quality criticism now sets the standard for what a modern, technology-forward franchise network can achieve.

"Domino's is a technology company that happens to sell pizza — and that distinction is the secret to its extraordinary success."

Executive Summary Scorecard

Dimension	Assessment	Rating
Brand Strength	Global recognition, 60+ year heritage	■■■■■
Franchise Model	Efficient, proven, high franchisee success rate	■■■■■
Technology	Industry-leading digital ordering ecosystem	■■■■■
Financial Performance	Consistent revenue growth, strong margins	■■■■■
Competitive Position	Leader in pizza delivery, under aggregator pressure	■■■■■
Innovation	Strong track record; ongoing investment required	■■■■■
Sustainability & Health	Lagging; requires strategic investment	■■■
Global Expansion	Robust pipeline; geopolitical risks managed	■■■■■

This report was prepared for academic and informational purposes. All statistics and data points are drawn from publicly available Domino's annual reports, SEC filings, press releases, and credible industry research sources.